ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** the second stanza	Cause moves to effect.
2	**(a)** concentrated	Compact.
3	**(b)** had not shaken	Third conditional.
4	**(a)** restraint and suggestion	Understatement.
5	**(c)** economy of form matched to a brief event	Compression.
6	**(b)** its ironic effect	Irony lost.
7	**(a)** a relative clause	Adjective clause.
8	**(d)** gloomy symbols bring relief	Irony.
9	**(c)** a slightly old-fashioned tone	Register.
10	**(b)** sad and low in spirits	Downcast.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He focuses on the inner effect (1) and uses symbolic images to deepen it (1).	1+1
12	A mere chance event changes feeling (1) so happiness may come unplanned (1).	1+1
13	It makes the experience personal (1) and invites readers to share it (1).	1+1
14	The title is light and pleasant (1) while the speaker begins in gloom, creating a mild irony (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It names the physical cause (1). It hints at lightness and delicacy (1). It misleads us to expect nature description only (1).	1+1+1
16	A single moment (1). Sudden shift (1). Emphasises the power of small events (1).	1+1+1
17	The poet exclaimed that it was a lovely change (1). Exclamation turns into a statement (1). Tense backshifts (1).	1+1+1
	OR: No strong adjectives (1). Brief clauses (1). The strong effect is left unstated, which makes it moving (1).	1+1+1
18	Hemlock suggests death (1). It gives a joyful effect (1). So life emerges from the symbol of death (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Whenever snow falls, I recall the poem (1). Despite his gloom, he smiled (1). Unless nature intervenes, moods stay low (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Structure (1). Imagery and symbolism (1). Tone and sound (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: First person (1). Tree and snow (1). Poet below (1). Rhyme (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Common event (1). Symbolic objects (1). Deep effect (1). Simple style (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Irony (1). Symbol (1). Structure (1). Interplay (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Taking 'crow' and 'hemlock' as symbols of good luck; they are traditionally **ill omens**, yet the dust of snow lifts the poet's mood: that is the contrast.
- Writing that the hemlock is the poisonous plant; here it is a **hemlock tree** (a conifer), so avoid calling it poison.
- Giving the wrong change of mood: the poet was in **regret and gloom**; the shower of snow saved part of his day, a tiny incident with a big effect.
- Mixing the device: 'the way a crow shook down on me the dust of snow' uses *imagery and simple language*; there is no simile in it.
- Ignoring the rhyme scheme **abab** (crow-snow, me-tree) and the poem's two short stanzas of four lines each.
- Spelling slips: *hemlock, rued, crow, Robert Frost, mood*; and 'rued' meaning regretted.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** contrast between sorrow and joy	Colour contrast.
2	**(d)** a small natural fact with large personal effect	Understated.
3	**(c)** The poet was open to being affected by nature	Receptive.
4	**(b)** the day was already partly lost	Salvaging.
5	**(d)** personal mood rather than politics	Personal lyric.
6	**(d)** an agent of change	It changes mood.
7	**(b)** sorrow and death	Associations.
8	**(a)** end rhyme in alternate lines	Gentle sounds.
9	**(b)** arbitrariness of mood	Mood is capricious.
10	**(b)** reflective lyric	A personal lyric.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Usually a bird of ill omen (1) but here a bringer of relief (1).	1+1
12	The mood is lifted but the whole day is not saved (1) leaving a sense of partial hope (1).	1+1
13	To keep the focus on mood (1) and to let readers relate their own regrets (1).	1+1
14	It is restrained and brief (1) and avoids emotional language (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Everyday words (1). Natural speech rhythm (1). Truth to common experience (1).	1+1+1
16	Crow brings a gift of snow (1). Fog is like a cat (1). Both act silently and leave mood changes (1).	1+1+1
17	dejected, despondent, mournful (1). The poet was dejected (1). Each word has a shade (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Nature affects the heart (1). A small event brings joy (1). The poet is receptive (1).	1+1+1
18	By noticing small joys (1). By discussing mood (1). By linking with nature walks (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Personification of the heart as receiver (1). It stresses emotion (1). It makes the mood a gift (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Event in nature (1). Mood shift (1). Receptive mind (1). Symbolism (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Nature event (1). Human response (1). Symbolism (1). Balance (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1
20	Both short (1). Different agents (1). Mood focus vs scene focus (1). Style (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Mindfulness (1). Tips (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Mixing the device: 'the way a crow shook down on me the dust of snow' uses *imagery and simple language*; there is no simile in it.
- Ignoring the rhyme scheme **abab** (crow-snow, me-tree) and the poem's two short stanzas of four lines each.
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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Fire and Ice	Both poems are by Robert Frost.
2	**(c)** a black crow and white snow	Contrast.
3	**(b)** The poem implies that nature's intervention is accidental, not planned	Chance event.
4	**(d)** not fully deep-seated	It could be lifted.
5	**(b)** a nature description only	The poem is about mood.
6	**(a)** conversational intimacy	Speech-like.
7	**(a)** how much was saved	Unspecified.
8	**(b)** Interprets the symbolism	Reader's inference.
9	**(d)** carry the thought across lines	Flow.
10	**(d)** Shaking the branch, the crow dropped snow.	Subject match.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Plain speech and rural imagery (1) with a quiet philosophic point (1).	1+1
12	Alternate rhymes give a quiet, steady music (1) matching the gentle mood (1).	1+1
13	It is neutral by action but friendly in effect (1) because it lifts the mood (1).	1+1
14	Optimistic in that mood lifts (1) realistic in that only part of the day is saved (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It keeps focus on mood (1). It lets readers fill in (1). But it also leaves a gap in context (1).	1+1+1
16	While I walked sadly under the hemlock (1), a crow shook down snow on my head (1). My mood suddenly lifted (1).	1+1+1
17	Soft tune (1). Slow tempo (1). Minor to major shift at the second stanza (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Soft consonants (1). Alternate end-rhymes (1). Short lines create quick, quiet music (1).	1+1+1
18	The crow shook the snow, which changed the poet's mood (1). 'Which' refers to the action (1). A non-restrictive clause (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Compactness gives focus (1). Every word counts (1). But some may want more detail (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Intro (1). Setting (1). Event (1). Effect (1). Reflection (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Stress is common (1). Poem shows relief from small events (1). Importance of breaks (1). Practical tips (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Reading (1). Analysis (1). Questions (1). Activity (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Question (1). Explanation (1). Discussion of symbol (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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